How to Make Money on TikTok: 7 Proven Methods That Actually Work

7 Proven Methods · That Work · 2026 | Updated October 28, 2026

Short Answer: TikTok provides several potential earning methods, including creator rewards, sponsored content, affiliate marketing, LIVE gifts, and TikTok Shop or other commerce features where available.

TikTok is no longer just a place to watch short entertaining videos. For creators, entrepreneurs, freelancers, and small businesses, it can also be a way to build an audience and create different income opportunities. If you've been searching for **how to make money on TikTok**, there are several legitimate methods worth exploring.

You can potentially earn directly through eligible TikTok monetization programs or indirectly by using your audience to promote products, services, affiliate offers, and businesses.

The best method depends on your niche, audience, location, and the type of content you create. In this guide, we'll look at **7 proven ways to make money on TikTok**, how each method works, and what you can do to get started.

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1. Earn Through the TikTok Creator Rewards Program

The first method to consider is TikTok's Creator Rewards Program, where available.

The program is designed to reward eligible creators for qualifying original videos. It is particularly relevant for creators who consistently produce their own content and have built an audience on the platform.

Many people still search for the **TikTok Creator Fund**, but TikTok has transitioned to the Creator Rewards Program in markets where the newer program is available.

Eligibility and availability can vary by country, so you should check the current requirements through TikTok's creator tools.

How it works

The basic process is:

1. Build an eligible TikTok account.
2. Publish original content.
3. Grow your audience and qualified video views.
4. Check the monetization options available in TikTok Studio.
5. Apply for the Creator Rewards Program if your account qualifies.
6. Continue following TikTok's content and monetization policies.

Being accepted into a program does not mean every video or every view automatically generates revenue. Qualified views and other program conditions determine eligibility for rewards.

2. Make Money Through Brand Partnerships

Brand sponsorships can become an important source of income once you've developed an audience in a specific niche.

Companies are often interested in creators who can introduce products to a relevant audience in an authentic way.

For example, a gaming TikTok account might collaborate with a gaming accessory company, while a beauty creator might work with a skincare brand.

Potential sponsored content can include:

* Product demonstrations
* Reviews
* Tutorials
* Unboxing videos
* Sponsored educational content
* Product comparisons
* Short promotional campaigns

You don't necessarily need millions of followers.

A smaller creator with a highly relevant audience can have value to a company because the audience may closely match its target customers.

What brands may consider

When evaluating creators, brands can look at:

* Follower count
* Engagement
* Audience demographics

* Content quality
* Niche
* Previous campaigns
* Location
* Video performance

If you accept a paid partnership, make sure the sponsorship is disclosed properly and complies with applicable advertising rules and TikTok requirements.

3. Use Affiliate Marketing

Affiliate marketing is another popular answer to **how to make money from TikTok**.

Instead of creating your own product, you recommend someone else's product or service. If a viewer makes a qualifying purchase through your referral, you can receive a commission.

Imagine you run a technology account.

You could create videos about:

* Wireless headphones
* Smartphones
* Laptop accessories
* Gaming keyboards
* Useful software
* Mobile applications

A video could explain how the product works and why someone might consider it.

The important part is that the product should fit your audience.

Why niche matters

Suppose you have 20,000 followers interested in budget technology.

A useful video about a $50 accessory may be more relevant to your audience than a random luxury product that has nothing to do with your content.

Trust is one of the biggest assets in affiliate marketing.

If viewers believe your recommendations are useful, they are more likely to investigate the products you mention.

4. Sell Your Own Products or Digital Products

You can also **make money on TikTok** by selling something you own.

This could be a physical product or a digital product.

Examples include:

* Ebooks
* Templates
* Printable resources
* Online courses
* Clothing
* Art
* Accessories
* Presets

* Guides
* Educational materials

For example, a photography creator could sell Lightroom presets. A fitness creator could offer a general workout guide. A graphic designer could sell editable templates.

TikTok can introduce your product to a large audience, while your store or sales platform handles the transaction.

Create content before promoting the product

Instead of making every video a direct advertisement, provide useful content first.

For example:

Video 1: 3 beginner photography mistakes

Video 2: How to improve indoor photos

Video 3: Best camera settings for beginners

Video 4: Before-and-after editing example

Then your product becomes a natural extension of the content.

5. Offer Services Through TikTok

If you have a skill, TikTok can be used to find clients.

This is especially useful for freelancers and professionals.

Potential services include:

* Video editing
* Graphic design
* Website development
* SEO
* Writing
* Photography
* Social media management
* Tutoring
* Coaching
* Consulting

For example, a video editor can post short clips showing how raw footage changes after editing.

A web designer can show website redesigns.

An SEO specialist can explain simple optimization techniques.

These videos demonstrate expertise and can encourage interested viewers to contact you.

In this model, you're not necessarily earning money from TikTok itself. Instead, TikTok becomes a marketing channel for your service business.

6. Monetize TikTok LIVE

TikTok LIVE can provide another opportunity for eligible creators to monetize their

audience.

LIVE sessions allow creators to interact directly with viewers.

Depending on the features available in your region and account, viewers may be able to send virtual gifts during eligible LIVE sessions.

You could use LIVE for:

* Gaming
* Q&A sessions
* Tutorials
* Music
* Product demonstrations
* Educational sessions
* Interviews
* Community discussions

The most important factor is interaction.

A LIVE session where viewers have questions and reasons to participate can be more engaging than simply turning on a camera without a plan.

Ideas for a better LIVE session

Before going LIVE, decide:

* What topic will you discuss?
* What questions will you answer?

* How long will the session last?
* What will viewers learn or experience?
* How will you encourage participation?

A simple plan can make the session easier to manage.

7. Use TikTok to Build Another Business

The final method is broader but potentially useful: use TikTok as a traffic and marketing channel for another business.

You could use TikTok to promote:

* An online store
* A website
* A newsletter
* A mobile application
* A course
* A membership
* A local business
* A consulting service
* A content website

For example, an online store could create short videos showing products in use.

A website owner could publish quick educational videos and encourage interested viewers to read the complete article.

A local restaurant could publish behind-the-scenes cooking videos and introduce new menu items.

In each case, TikTok helps attract attention while the business generates revenue elsewhere.

How Do You Make Money on TikTok Without Millions of Followers?

You don't necessarily need a huge audience to begin exploring monetization.

The answer depends on the income method.

If you're selling a service, for example, you may only need a small number of relevant potential customers.

If you're using affiliate marketing, the number of people who actually click and purchase can matter more than total followers.

If you're working with brands, companies may look at engagement and audience relevance in addition to follower count.

This means **how do you make money on TikTok** is not simply a question of reaching a particular follower number.

It's about finding a monetization method that matches your audience.

How to Make Money on TikTok Videos

Your videos are the foundation of almost every TikTok income strategy.

If your content doesn't attract attention, monetization becomes much harder.

Consider using formats such as:

Educational videos

Teach one useful idea in a short, easy-to-understand format.

Product reviews

Explain what a product does and who might benefit from it.

Tutorials

Show viewers how to accomplish something.

Before-and-after videos

These work particularly well for editing, design, beauty, cleaning, organization, and other visual niches.

Lists

Create useful lists such as:

* 5 useful apps
* 7 beginner tips
* 3 mistakes to avoid
* 10 useful tools

Stories

Personal experiences and interesting stories can make your content more memorable.

The goal isn't simply to create videos that get views. You want to create content that attracts the type of audience that can support your chosen monetization method.

How to Get Monetized on TikTok

If you're specifically interested in **how to get monetized on TikTok**, start by checking which monetization features are available to your account.

TikTok's requirements can differ based on the program and region.

A general approach is:

1. Create an account that follows TikTok's policies.
2. Choose a clear content category.
3. Publish original videos consistently.
4. Build genuine engagement.
5. Check TikTok Studio for available monetization programs.
6. Review the current requirements.
7. Apply when eligible.
8. Continue monitoring your account's monetization options.

Avoid relying on old articles that list a single follower or view number as a universal monetization requirement.

TikTok's programs and requirements can change.

What Happened to the TikTok Creator Fund?

The term **TikTok Creator Fund** remains popular because it was the name associated

with an earlier creator monetization initiative.

TikTok has since introduced the Creator Rewards Program in markets where it is available.

If you're researching the Creator Fund because you want to earn from TikTok videos, check the current creator monetization options available in your country instead of assuming information about the older program still applies.

Creator Rewards Program in the Philippines

Creators searching for the **Creator Rewards Program in the Philippines** should verify the current availability directly through their TikTok account.

Monetization programs can vary by market, and requirements applicable in one country may not apply to creators elsewhere.

Before building your entire income strategy around the program, check the latest eligibility requirements and available features for your location.

How Much Can You Make on TikTok?

There isn't one fixed amount that every TikTok creator earns.

Your potential income depends on the monetization method and your results.

For example:

Creator program: Rewards may depend on qualified views and applicable program rules.

Affiliate marketing: Income depends on clicks, conversions, and commission rates.

Brand deals: Payment depends on the campaign, creator, audience, content requirements, and other factors.

Services: Income depends on how many clients you attract and what you charge.

Products: Revenue depends on sales, pricing, costs, and profit margins.

Therefore, follower count alone cannot tell you how much a TikTok account can earn.

Can You Make Money on TikTok Without Going Viral?

Yes, different monetization methods can work without relying entirely on viral videos.

A niche creator may build an audience around a specific topic and monetize that audience through products, services, affiliate offers, or partnerships.

For example, a creator with a smaller audience of dedicated photography enthusiasts may have opportunities to promote photography equipment or editing products.

The audience's relevance can be important.

Tips to Increase Your TikTok Earning Opportunities

Choose one clear audience

Instead of trying to appeal to everyone, identify the people you want watching your videos.

Solve problems

Useful content gives viewers a reason to follow your account.

Be consistent

Regular posting gives you more opportunities to test topics and formats.

Study your analytics

Look at which videos generate views, watch time, comments, shares, and profile visits.

Don't chase every trend

Trends can help with discovery, but they don't always fit your niche.

Build trust

Avoid exaggerated income claims and misleading product recommendations.

Diversify your income

Once you have an audience, consider more than one monetization method.

Mistakes That Can Hurt Your TikTok Monetization

There are several shortcuts that are not worth relying on.

Avoid:

* Buying followers

* Buying views
* Using copyrighted content without permission
* Copying other creators' videos
* Making misleading financial claims
* Spamming promotional links
* Promoting products unrelated to your niche
* Ignoring TikTok's policies

A genuine audience is much more useful than an inflated follower number.

Frequently Asked Questions

How do you make money on TikTok?
Creators can potentially earn through TikTok's eligible monetization programs, LIVE features, sponsorships, affiliate marketing, products, services, and other business opportunities.

How can I make money from TikTok videos?
You can explore creator programs, sponsorships, affiliate marketing, product sales, and services. The best option depends on your content and audience.

Can you make money on TikTok with a small following?
Yes. Some methods, such as services, affiliate marketing, and selling products, can be pursued without having a massive audience.

How do I get monetized on TikTok?
Check TikTok Studio or your creator tools for monetization programs available to your account, then review the current requirements for each program.

Is the TikTok Creator Fund still available?

TikTok has moved toward the Creator Rewards Program in markets where that program is available. Current options vary by region.

Does TikTok pay you for every video?

No. Payment depends on the specific monetization method and its eligibility requirements. Simply uploading a video does not guarantee payment.

Final Thoughts

There are several legitimate answers to **how to make money on TikTok**.

You can explore the Creator Rewards Program, brand partnerships, affiliate marketing, products, services, LIVE features, or use TikTok to grow another business.

The important step is choosing a method that fits your content and audience rather than trying every monetization strategy at once.

Start by creating useful original videos, build trust with a specific audience, monitor your results, and gradually introduce monetization methods that make sense for your niche.

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